

vertigo!!

Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club, Wellington Section

NO. 653 February 2003 PO BOX 1628 WELLINGTON

www.nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

Club nights are at Turnbull House,¹ on the first clear Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meet for dinner at the Backbencher² at 6.30 and on to Turnbull House at 7.30 pm for a catch up. Meetings, run with an iron fist jam by "Al" Presidente Lowrie, start with precision at 8.00 pm with club business. Talks kick-off on the whistle at 8.01 pm.



Summer barbecue at Fergs Rock and Kayak. Monday 3rd of February, 6 pm onwards

FREE CLIMBING AND FOOD AND BEVERAGES WILL BE AVAILABLE ON MONDAY 3RD OF FEBRUARY FOR ALL WELLINGTON SECTION MEMBERS AND FRIENDS. SO...IF YOU HAVE ONE, BRING ONE!

THE BARBECUE IS A FUN SOCIAL NIGHT FOR ALL CLIMBERS, A CHANCE TO MEET SOME NEW FACES, AN OPPORTUNITY TO CATCH UP WITH THE HOLIDAY GOINGS ON, AS WELL AS PROVIDING POTENTIAL TO ORGANIZE NEW AND EXCITING THINGS FOR LATER IN THE YEAR.

BRING YOUR FRIENDS AND ENJOY FREE CLIMBING AT FERGS, TASTY BARBECUE MORSELS, AND A BROAD ASSORTMENT OF ALCOHOLIC AND NON-ALCOHOLIC BEVIES. BUT NO DRINKING AND CLIMBING!

THIS YEAR ALPINE ADDICTS CAN UPDATE THEIR TRANSCEIVER SKILLS IN THE NEARBY SAND VOLLEY BALL COURTS. THE CHALLENGE IS TO RESCUE THE MYSTERY PRIZE AND CLAIM IT AS YOUR OWN!

¹ On Bowen Street, squashed behind the Treasury on Number 1 the Terrace.

² On Molesworth Street, opposite Parliament.

ALL IN ALL IT WILL BE A GOOD NIGHT AND YOUR ONLY EXCUSE FOR MISSING IT IS THAT YOU ARE OUT OF TOWN!

Upcoming section night reminders

March

In March we will be having another of our popular short talks nights. Contact Caroline (cd@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz) if you have a few slides from your summer adventures that we should see.

April

In April it is our AGM and Richard Wesley.



Benefits of club membership: Cheap climbing at Fergs

As an Alpine Club member you can now climb at Fergs Rock and Kayak for only \$5 EVERY Monday night, and at any other time for only \$8 (usually \$12). Make sure you carry your card and that your membership is up to date.

For those who are interested, this is a potential saving of \$2,756.00 every year! Or, if you just climb once a week on a Monday, you will save \$364.00. This becomes a \$284.00 PROFIT after you pay your Alpine Club membership. At least enough for a weekend trip to The Bay (or maybe the mountain if you're of that persuasion).

This doesn't take into account the fact that you will all, of course, be at the 10 Section nights we have each year....

Our website

Reminder about our web site www.nzalpine.wellington.net.nz.

DISCUSSION GROUP - Over half of Wellington section members are now subscribed to our free email discussion group. If you would like to get or communicate articles of interest, trip details and other information then go to our web site www.nzalpine.wellington.net.nz for instructions on how to join.

Powerband National bouldering series/Baring Head Rock Hop 10 am-2 pm, 25th January, Baring Head

The Powerband national bouldering series and Baring Head Rock hop is on again on Saturday 25th of January. Suitable for all ages and skill levels, there is both an experts and a recreational categories for various ages and sexes.

The cost of entry is \$10. Register from 9.30 am. Kicks off at 10 am and you have 4 hours to do your thing.

As ever, there will be prizes for both the winners and spot prizes, plus the usual barbecue put on by the alpine club in the Catchpool area of the Rimutaka forest park afterwards.

For those not in the know, Baring Head can be reached by driving through Wainuiomata, and taking a big right onto the road heading to the coast. Immediately on hitting the south coast, park your transport and walk west along the beach, fording the river and heading for the pile of rocks on the south eastern head of the harbour which is Baring Head.

For more details on the Powerband National bouldering series, go cyber on <http://www.powerband.org.nz> or contact "Mad" Matt Bayliss on 025 232 0852 or hm 569 7472.

Sponsored by Bivouac, the NZAC, and Cactus Climbing

NZAC Wellington Section: **Summer rock climbing course**

Summer rock is on! Do something with your summer! Learn climbing technique, anchor set-ups, knots, rope work, belaying, abseiling, and safe top-roping on real rock! Go away on trips! With a two to one student-instructor ratio.

Monday 10th February: 7 pm evening session.

Saturday 15th February: Day trip to Baring Head.

Monday 17th February: 7 pm evening session.

Saturday 22nd February: Day trip to Titahi Bay.

Monday 24th February: 7 pm evening session.

Saturday 1st and Sunday 2nd March: 1st weekend away to Mangetepopo, Tongariro National Park.

Monday 10th March: 7 pm evening session.

Saturday 15th and Sunday 16th March: 2nd weekend away to Kinloch, northern shore of Lake Taupo.

Cost: \$400 non-members (includes membership of the Alpine Club) and \$320 for members. Transport costs for all trips and dinner costs for weekend trips included. Ropes etc. provided. \$50 deposit.

A post-course trip will be organized. The popular & fun limestone crag of Payne's Ford near Takaka is a typical destination.

For more details contact Scott Taylor on
380 0913 or Matt Spittal on 380 1095



Section news: An appeal to share 'n grow!

Tell us what you are doing out there – we want to hear about what everyone is doing out there. Please send your trip reports to newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz so everyone can enjoy your stories, tall or short. That's YOU!!!

Weather a Hart-stopper

Have just been down at Cook - returned yesterday. We managed to get up Hochstetter Dome and Aylmer before 5 days of snow and wind dropped 1.5m of snow at Tasman Saddle. The wind has compacted most of it so foot penetration is about ankle depth, however there is plenty of lee slope deposition making many of the routes dangerous. An exit down the Tasman glacier in blizzard conditions over two days was "interesting", 15cm of snow at Ball shelter. I rang a friend at Unwin today and the clouds are down to the village with Aussie forecast showing a continuation of the unsettled westerly airflows for the rest of the week—Steve Hart

Very little bits

The editor had a fun time playing at bouldering at Lindfield in Sydney over Christmas – a great and very easily accessible crag in inner-city suburban Sydney if you're in the area. Personal highlight was doing the Tourist Route third go at V3. The Balkans looked too hard! Jo Roberts and John Barnes hiked up "Red Arete" at Mt Cook over the same period and doubtless did other more gnarly things.

For sale: alpine stuff

Climbing Equipment for sale:

Fairydown Goretex tent, used but in good condition, \$400. Tubbs snowshoes, new \$250 Asolo AFX plastics, U.K.7, excellent condition \$250. Primus Multifuel stove, liquid fuels or gas, great for travelling or climbing \$150. Salewa mountaineering crampons, \$100 Grivel anti-balling plates \$15. Kadadyn swiss made water filter \$170. Camelbak - the original 2 litre \$50. Lifelink snow shovel, telescoping handle, \$50 Ice screw, 20cm, \$15 Avalance Probe, S.O.S., excellent mechanism, \$120. All in great nick. Call Pete 021 473 834 to check it out. Reasonable offers considered.

Want some skiing gear?

Dynastar Max Zero skis (190 cm) with Salomon 997 bindings, Nordica Extreme Super Carve ski boots (size 28.5 or NZ 10), Thule Magnum 730 ski rack, Scott 7000 poles (130 cm) and Killy ski pants (32 inch). All mint condition. \$1250. Telephone Andrew on 04-473-8115.

Great gloves!

For Sale: OR (Outdoor Research) Gore-Tex Mitts Expedition/top-of-the-line mitts, outer Gore-Tex, full wrist/lower forearm cover, detachable fibre pile inner, Large/Medium size, worn once. Tel: Philippa 479 9298.

Flatmate wanted for climbing flat

Large double room in turn of the century Newtown house. Sunny aspect, quiet cul de sac. All mod cons including central heating to fight those winter chills. Handy to shops, bus stops, hospital if you injure yourself. Cost \$110 single \$130 for a couple plus usual expenses. Interested people please phone Scott a/h 380 0913.

And here are the club trips for 2003...

Easter 2003 18th to 27th April 2003 - Wilkin Valley Exploration,

Easter Weekend and ANZAC day = only 3 days leave for 9 days away! There are a host of peaks around the area to satisfy a range of skills. The Wilkin Valley is in Aspiring National Park. Objectives could include Castor, Pollux, Alba. Easy tramping is available. Please show your interest early, because transport booking has to be made well in advance.

Contact: Don French don.f@xtra.co.nz. phone: 06 377 7117

Queens Birthday Weekend 2003 – The Inland Kaikouras

A chance to taste early winter snow in the inland Kaikouras. Kevin Patterson is planning to get to Tapuouenuku next June. To get in quick with your place contact him at: Kevin.Patterson@nzmp.com, ph:04 566 0975

Post Monsoon 2004 (September/October)

How about a slightly longer trip - to Nepal? Several people have indicated interest in a section climbing trip to attempt several trekking peaks, Island Peak and Lobuje East have been suggested as reasonably straightforward

objectives. This could include a non-climbing trek party also. Trip leaders for both are emerging as discussions go on. To indicate an initial interest email the trip co-ordinator, trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz.

Other Sections trips

Don't forget there are other sections of the NZAC out there. Check out there trips by going onto the main website www.nzalpine.org.nz and clicking on the individual section newsletters.

Thanks to everyone making an effort to generate club trips. Remember, trips can be any length, any level of difficulty and any size (a trip of two people is just as valid as a trip of ten – but can you take a trip by yourself? Ed.). We have a trip template and plenty of suggestions for those who want to give it a go. Do contact me even if you want ideas for private trips. Nothing will be set in stone! sh@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, or phone 04-9738079



Wellington Section Directory: 2002 contact list

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